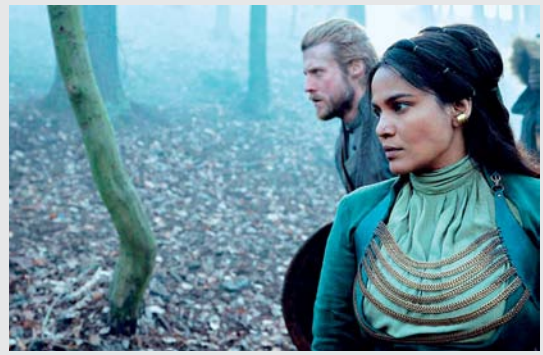










↘ SPOT OUR FOLK
(clockwise from far left) Dhanush in *The Gray Man*, Mohan Kapur in *Ms Marvel*, Priyanka Bose in *The Wheel of Time*, Randeep Hooda in *Extraction*, Huma Qureshi in *Army of the Dead* and Kubbra Sait in *Foundation*

Bose (*The Wheel of Time*), Randeep Hooda and Priyanshu Painyuli (*Extraction*), Huma Qureshi (*Army of the Dead*) and, more recently, Dhanush (*The Gray Man*) have landed parts in popular American web series and films. Why, Delhi-born Anupam Tripathi appeared in a K-drama too, in *The Squid Game*. The crossover isn't stopping anytime soon as Alia Bhatt makes her international debut in Netflix's *Heart of Stone*. Says Kapur, "There's so much genius in the country that it's only right that they get their moment in the sun."

BREAKING BOUNDARIES, CHANGING THE GAME

At the centre of this cultural exchange is casting director Tess Joseph, who is popular among producers and studios based in London and Los Angeles. Nearly half of her work comes from abroad, and she has been roped in by the makers of *Foundation*, *The Wheel of Time* and *The White Tiger*. As production companies in Hollywood go for colour-blind casting to raise their diversity quotient, the Indian actor is getting to play more than the role of a doctor, a terrorist, a nerdy techie or a cabbie. Stereotypes now are few and far between and there's a healthy dialogue to avoid caricatures like Apu in *The Simpsons*. Joseph, who has been in the field for over a decade, says that "the scope is endless" as genres like fantasy and sci-fi find an audience, opening up space for characters that

SPECIAL APPEARANCE

↘ ALIA BHATT
Heart of Stone (Netflix)
"It's probably the quickest film I've shot," says Bhatt of her international debut, filmed while pregnant. "The crew took such good care of me"



↘ ADARSH GOURAV
Extrapolations (Apple TV)
After rave reviews for his performance in The White Tiger, it didn't take long for Gourav to land a part in this anthology, which also features Meryl Streep



↘ NIMRAT KAUR
Foundation (Apple TV)
After having landed US television shows like *Homeland* and *Wayward Pines*, *Kaur* makes her streaming debut playing a quantum physicist in season two of the sci-fi series that had Kubbra Sait in the first season

↘ SIKANDER KHER & SOBHITA DHULIPALA
Monkey Man (Netflix)
Kher plays the antagonist in the revenge drama that marks the directorial debut of *Slumdog Millionaire* actor Dev Patel

